



Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

June 6, 2023

Sent Via Electronic Mail

Ryan Hayes
Deputy Director of Public Works
City of Atascadero
6500 Palma Ave
Atascadero, CA, 93422
e-mail: rhayes@atascadero.org

Dear Ryan Hayes,

**ATASCADERO WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY, 8005 GABARDA RD,
ATASCADERO, CA, 93422, SAN LUIS OBISPO COUNTY:**

- **NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY FOR ENROLLMENT IN ORDER NO. R3-2020-0020, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR DISCHARGES FROM DOMESTIC WASTEWATER SYSTEMS WITH FLOWS GREATER THAN 100,000 GALLONS PER DAY;**
- **TRANSMITTAL OF MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2023-0026; AND**
- **TERMINATION OF INDIVIDUAL PERMIT, WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 01-014 FOR ATASCADERO WATER RECLAMATION FACILITY.**

The Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board) reviewed the November 30, 2021 notice of intent and available documents associated with City of Atascadero's domestic wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) located at 8005 Gabarda Avenue in Atascadero, California. The Wastewater System, owned by City of Atascadero is currently regulated pursuant to *Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 01-014 for City of Atascadero Wastewater Treatment Facility, City of Atascadero, San Luis Obispo County* (Order No. 01-014).

On September 25, 2020, the Central Coast Water Board adopted *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

JANE GRAY, CHAIR | MATTHEW T. KEELING, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

This letter serves as a notice of applicability for enrollment in the General Permit. This letter includes: wastewater system operation summary, specific requirements, and limitations (Attachment 1); figures (Attachment 2); and the City of Atascadero's monitoring and reporting program requirements (Attachment 3).

This letter also serves as a notice of termination of the City of Atascadero's coverage in existing individual permit, Order No. 01-014.

The City of Atascadero must comply with the following:

1. **General Permit** – The City of Atascadero must comply with all conditions and requirements of the General Permit. As described in the General Permit, ongoing operation, maintenance, monitoring, and reporting are required. A copy of the General Permit can be found electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/r32020_0020.pdf

2. **Monitoring and Reporting Program** – The City of Atascadero must comply with the requirements of the monitoring and reporting program enclosed with this letter (monitoring and reporting program no. R3-2023-0026, Attachment 3). The City of Atascadero is required to submit quarterly monitoring reports and annual reports to the Central Coast Water Board and comply with annual volumetric reporting requirements¹ established by the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board). The first quarterly monitoring report is due **November 1, 2023**, the first annual report is due **March 1, 2024**, and the annual volumetric data submission must be uploaded to the State Water Board GeoTracker database by **April 30, 2024**.

Quarterly monitoring reports and annual reports must be provided electronically in searchable PDF with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permitting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

All annual reports must be formatted and completed as specified in the annual report template found at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

¹ See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

The City of Atascadero must submit all reports/documents and laboratory data (using the transmittal sheet as the cover page) to the publicly accessible State Water Board's GeoTracker^{2,3} database with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System – specific global identification number **WDR100026749** over the internet at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/index.html

The attached monitoring and reporting program outlines the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. The Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

3. **Fees** – The City of Atascadero paid an annual fee of \$24,687 on February 1, 2023 for coverage in existing individual permit, Order No. 01-014. This payment covers the City of Atascadero's enrollment in the General Permit for the 2022-2023 fiscal year.

The City of Atascadero must pay an annual fee to maintain coverage in the General Permit. Annual fees are determined by the State Water Board's fee program and cover the state fiscal year of July 1 through June 30. Your current annual fee is \$24,687. A copy of the current state fee schedule is available electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr

The City of Atascadero's Wastewater System is currently assigned a threat and complexity rating of 2B.

4. **Notification** – The Central Coast Water Board will be notified of the City of Atascadero's enrollment at a regularly scheduled public meeting August 24-25, 2023. Details about that meeting are available on our website at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_info/agendas/

5. **Future Discharge Modifications** – Pursuant to California Water Code section 13260, the City of Atascadero must inform the Central Coast Water Board at least 120 days prior to modifying your discharge. If there are any significant changes in either treatment or disposal methodologies, or the volume or

² Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/docs/beginnerguid2.pdf

³ Additional information available at: <http://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

character of the treated wastewater, the City of Atascadero must notify the Central Coast Water Board immediately of such changes.

Attachment 1 contains the Central Coast Water Board's understanding of the Wastewater System located at 8005 Gabarda Road, Atascadero, California, 93422. Please review Attachment 1 to determine if the description is representative of your current system. Pursuant to California Water Code section 13267, the City of Atascadero must notify the Central Coast Water Board if this information is out of date or incorrect. You are required to provide staff with your updated information within **30 days** of issuance of this letter.

- 6. Responsible Party** – The City of Atascadero is responsible for the management and disposal of the domestic wastewater in compliance with the conditions of the General Permit. Any noncompliance with this General Permit constitutes a violation of the California Water Code, and subjects the City of Atascadero to enforcement action, and termination of enrollment under this General Permit.
- 7. Change in Ownership** - In the event of any change in control or ownership of the property, the City of Atascadero must notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this General Permit by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to the Central Coast Water Board so that the new owner or operator can be enrolled in the General Permit and the City of Atascadero's enrollment in the General Permit can be terminated.
- 8. Termination of Permit** - The existing individual permit, Order No. 01-014 is terminated, except for enforcement purposes⁴. The City of Atascadero is responsible for compliance with Order No. 01-014 prior to the date of this letter.

If you have any questions, please contact **James Bishop at (805) 542-4628 or by email at James.Bishop@Waterboards.ca.gov** or Jennifer Epp at (805) 594-6181 or by email at Jennifer.Epp@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

 Digitally signed by Jennifer Epp
Date: 2023.06.06 12:23:22 -07'00'
Water Boards

for Matthew T. Keeling
Executive Officer

⁴ The General Permit states "... where a Wastewater System discharge is currently regulated by an individual permit, that permit is terminated upon the enrollment of the Wastewater System into this General Permit."

Attachments:

Attachment 1: Wastewater System Operation Summary, Specific Requirements, and Limitations

Attachment 2: Figures

Attachment 3: Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R3-2023-0026

cc:

City of Atascadero, publicworks@atascadero.org

Nick Debar, ndebar@atascadero.org

Tim Cleaver, tcleaver@atascadero.org

Josh Heptig, jheptig@co.slo.ca.us

Jennifer Epp, Central Coast Water Board, Jennifer.Epp@Waterboards.ca.gov

James Bishop, Central Coast Water Board, James.Bishop@Waterboards.ca.gov

Jesse Woodard, Central Coast Water Board, Jesse.Woodard@Waterboards.ca.gov

WDR Program, RB3-WDR@Waterboards.ca.gov *GeoTracker*

ECM/CIWQS = CW-206653

GeoTracker No. = GT-WDR100026749

ECM Subject Name = Atascadero Wastewater Treatment Facility NOA for R3-2020-2020

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NOA MRP City of Atascadero_final.docx

**ATTACHMENT 1
WASTEWATER SYSTEM OPERATION SUMMARY, SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS,
AND LIMITATIONS**

1. OWNERSHIP AND WASTEWATER SYSTEM INFORMATION

Ownership and wastewater system information submitted by the City of Atascadero to the Central Coast Water Board is shown in Table 1.

Table 1. Ownership and Wastewater System Information

Name	Atascadero Wastewater Treatment Facility
Physical Address	8005 Gabarda Road Atascadero, CA, 93422
Latitude	35.482182°
Longitude	-120.644122°
Mailing Address	6500 Palma Avenue, Atascadero, CA, 93422
Owner	City of Atascadero
Operator	Timothy Cleaver phone: 805-470-3132 e-mail: tcleaver@atascadero.org
Legally Responsible Official	Ryan Hayes e-mail: rhayes@atascadero.org
Raw Wastewater Characteristics	Sewer Connections: 5,500 Population Served: Approximately 15,000 Domestic (%): 99.9% Industrial (%): 0.1%
Permitted Average Monthly Design Flow (gallons per day, gpd)	1,400,000
Baseline Flow (average annual flow) in gpd	1,260,000
Threat to Water Quality	2
Complexity	B
Chalk Mountain Golf Course Irrigation Operator	Josh Heptig Golf Superintendent San Luis Obispo County Parks 805-781-1318 jheptig@co.slo.ca.us

2. WASTEWATER SYSTEM OPERATION SUMMARY

The Atascadero Water Treatment Facility wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) is a Class II wastewater system. The City of Atascadero must staff a Grade II

chief plant operator for proper operation of the Wastewater System. Current operator names, grades, and license numbers are shown in Table 2.

Table 2. Wastewater System Operators

Operator Name	Grade	License Number
Timm Cleaver	II	27668
Justin Kamp	II	42545
Vincent Corcoran	OIT	—
Ebony Lucian	OIT	—

The Wastewater System is capable of treating a 1,400,000 gallons per day to a Secondary treatment level. The Wastewater System consists of the treatment technologies and treatment capabilities shown in Table 3.

Table 3. Treatment Technology and Capacity

Headworks/Preliminary Treatment	Two (2) automated barscreens, one (1) overflowchannel with manual barscreen and including a screw compactor. Connected to SCADA/alarm system.	
	Headworks capacity (gpd): 5.0 MGD	
Primary Treatment	Oxidation Lagoon - Seven (7) surface aerator	
	Primary treatment capacity (gpd): 1,400,000	
Secondary Treatment	Facultative Lagoon - Two (2) facultative lagoons	
	Secondary treatment capacity (gpd): 1,400,000	
Tertiary Treatment	N/A	
	Tertiary treatment capacity (gpd): N/A	
Disinfection	The system does not include disinfection.	
	Disinfection Capacity (gpd): N/A	
Wastewater Disposal Method	Discharge to land - infiltration basin is approximately 960,000 square feet	
	Disposal capacity (gpd): 2,550,000	
Biosolids/Sludge Production and Handling	System includes solids pumping by dredgeing, dewatering through drying beds and spreading/storage area.	
	Annual production of biosolids: 300 tons	
	The ultimate destination of biosolids produced is a facility licensed to accept Class B biosolids. Currently, this is Engel & Gray, Inc. located at 745 Betteravia Road, Santa Maria, CA 9345	
Non-Potable Recycled Water	Non-potable recycled water produced onsite:	None
	Recycled water usage areas:	None
	Enrolled in WQ 2016-0068-DDW:	No

	Recycled water production volume (gpd):	N/A
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A summary of historic and recent average effluent concentrations is included in Table 4. The Central Coast Water Board used reported effluent water quality data to establish the effluent and groundwater limitations in section 3.

Table 4. 2021 Effluent Water Quality for Select Constituents

Constituents	Units	Annual Average for 2021 ^[1]
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L ^[2]	4.3
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	28
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	820
Chloride	mg/L	180
Sodium	mg/L	145
Sulfate	mg/L	123
Boron	mg/L	0.3
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	28
Nitrate as Nitrogen	mg/L	0.4

[1] Based on water quality data reported by the City of Atascadero's 2021 Annual Monitoring Report.

[2] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter

An irrigation well located approximately 600 feet north of the disposal ponds provides water to the Chalk Mountain Golf Course. Annual average total coliform concentrations measured by the City of Atascadero in weekly samples collected from the irrigation well are shown in Table 5.

Table 5. Irrigation Well Water Quality

Constituents	Units	Annual Average for 2021 ^[1]
Total Coliform	MPN/100 mL ^[2]	3.0

[1] MPN/100 mL denotes most probable number per 100 milliliters

[2] Based on water quality data reported by the City of Atascadero's in the 2021 Annual Monitoring Report.

3. WASTEWATER SYSTEM SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AND LIMITATIONS

The City of Atascadero must operate the Wastewater System in accordance with the General Permit and this notice of applicability.

A. Flow Limitations:

The City of Atascadero must comply with the wastewater specific limitations specified in Table 6.

Table 6. Flow Limitations

Flow	Units	Limit	Point of Compliance
Monthly Average Flow ^[1]	Gallons per day	1,400,000	Influent
Peak Wet Weather Flow ^[2]	Gallons per day	2,550,000	Influent
Monthly Average Flow ^[1] to disposal area	Gallons per day	2,330,000	Effluent
Maximum Effluent Flow ^[2] to disposal area	Gallons per day	2,550,000	Effluent

[1] Monthly average flow rate is the total discharge to the headworks by volume during a calendar month divided by the number of days in the month that the wastewater system was discharging.

[2] The maximum daily flow rate allowed during storm events.

B. Effluent Limitations:

The City of Atascadero must comply with the wastewater specific limitations specified in Table 7.

Table 7. Effluent Limitations: Pond Systems

Constituent	Units	30-Day Average	7-Day Average	Sample Maximum
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L ^{[1][2]}	45	65	Not Applicable
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	45	65	Not Applicable
Settleable Solids	mL/L ^[3]	0.3	Not Applicable	0.5
pH	Not Applicable	Between 6.5 and 8.4	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

[1] mg denotes milligrams

[2] L denotes liters

[3] mL denotes milliliters

C. Interim Effluent Limitations

Interim effluent limitations are shown in Table 8 apply until June 6, 2025.

Table 8. Interim Effluent Limitations

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median ^[1]
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	1000
Chloride	mg/L	250
Sodium	mg/L	200

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median ^[1]
Boron	mg/L	1
Nitrate as N	mg/L	8

[1] Rolling Median is the median from all data collected over the most recent 25 months

D. Final Effluent or Groundwater Limitations

On June 6, 2025, the interim effluent limitations shown in either Table 9 or Table 10 apply, depending on the compliance pathway chosen by the City of Atascadero. **If the City of Atascadero does not notify the Central Coast Water Board regarding the preferred compliance pathway by June 6, 2025, then the effluent limits in Table 9 are automatically applied as the final limits.**

If more than 24 months is needed to comply with final limits, the City of Atascadero must have a Time Schedule Compliance Plan that has been approved by the Central Coast Water Board Executive Officer. Once the compliance pathway is chosen, the Notice of Applicability will be re-issued and will include the compliance choice. The monitoring and reporting program will also be updated accordingly.

**Table 9. Final Effluent Limitations (Beginning June 6, 2025)
Based on Designated Groundwater Basins - Paso Robles Area Atascadero**

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L ^[1]	550
Chloride	mg/L	70
Sodium	mg/L	65
Sulfate	mg/L	85
Boron	mg/L	0.3
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	10

Table 10. Final Groundwater Limitations (Beginning June 6, 2025) for Designated Groundwater Basins - Paso Robles Area Atascadero

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L ^[1]	550
Chloride	mg/L	70
Sodium	mg/L	65
Sulfate	mg/L	85
Boron	mg/L	0.3
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	2.3

**ATTACHMENT 2
FIGURES**



Figure 1. Small Scale Site Map and Monitoring Locations



Figure 2. Site Map of Treatment Facility

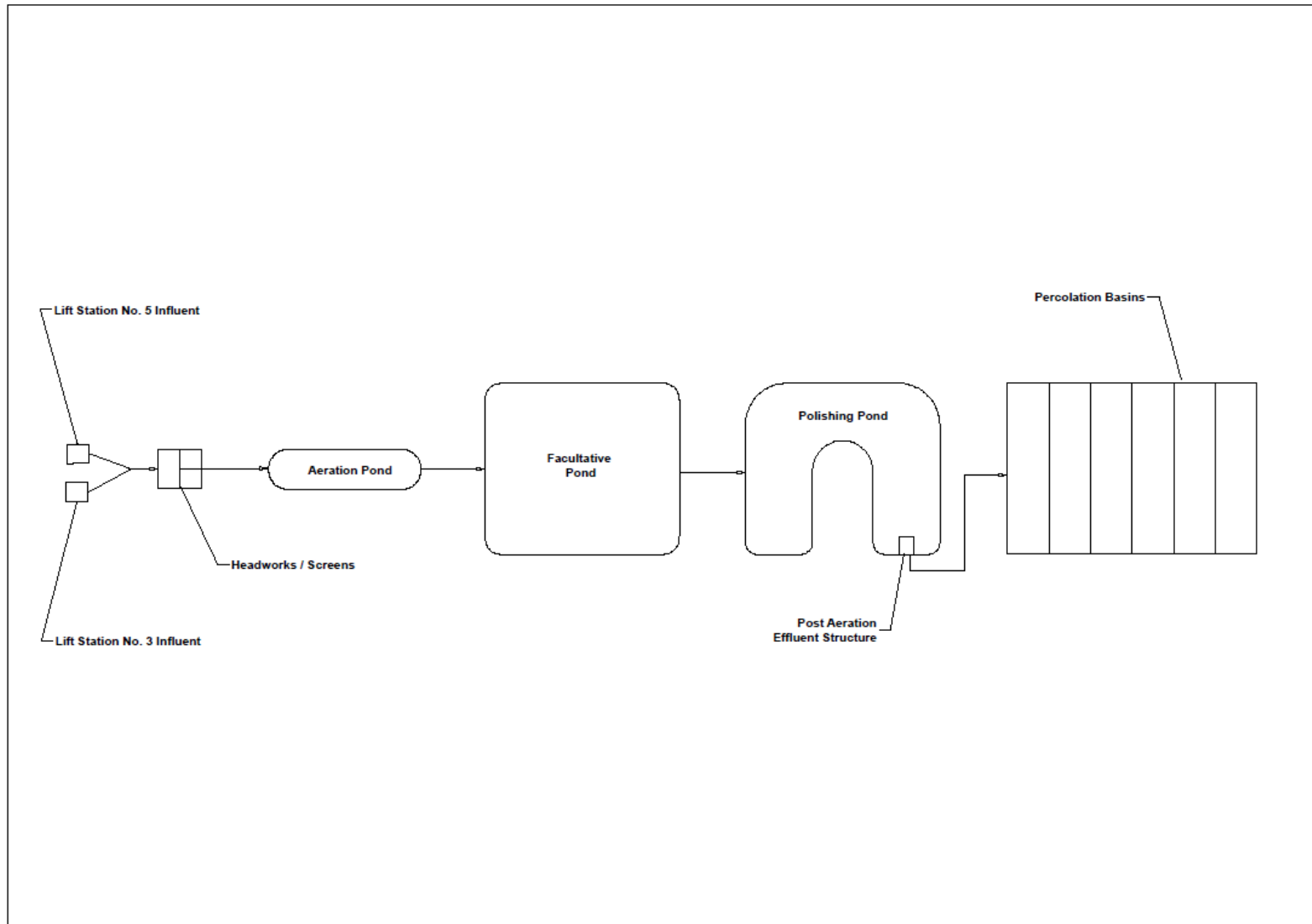


Figure 3. Wastewater Process Flow Diagram

**ATTACHMENT 3
CENTRAL COAST REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2023-0026
FOR
CITY OF ATASCADERO WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
ATASCADERO, SAN LUIS OBISPO COUNTY**

This Monitoring and Reporting Program applies to the monitoring and reporting requirements for the City of Atascadero's Atascadero Wastewater Treatment Facility (Wastewater System) enrolled in *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

The City of Atascadero owns and operates the Wastewater System that is subject to the General Permit and notice of applicability. The City of Atascadero must not implement any changes to this monitoring and reporting program unless and until a revised monitoring and reporting program is issued by the Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board).

The State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) and Regional Water Quality Control Boards are transitioning to the use of the publicly accessible State Water Board's GeoTracker database for the tracking of environmental and regulatory data for sites that operate under waste discharge requirements. The monitoring and reporting program directs the City of Atascadero to submit reports (both technical and monitoring reports) and analytical data electronically to the State Water Board's GeoTracker database (see monitoring and reporting program section 7.D).

1. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

The City of Atascadero must collect representative samples in accordance with the most recently approved sampling and analysis plan contained in the Operations and Maintenance Manual and validate analytical results prior to submittal to the Central Coast Water Board. All samples (e.g., wastewater, groundwater, soil, sludge) must be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge or matrix of materials sampled.

All samples must be collected by a qualified person, trained in proper procedures for collecting the samples. The name of the sampler, sample type (grab or composite), time, date, location, bottle/container type, and any preservative used for each sample must be recorded on the sample chain of custody form. The chain of custody form must also contain all custody information including date, time, and to whom samples were relinquished. If composite samples are collected, the basis for sampling (time or flow weighted) must be included in the sampling and analysis plan contained in the

Operations and Maintenance Manual for Central Coast Water Board review and approval.

- A. Sampling Schedule** – Unless otherwise specified below, sampling must be performed in accordance with Table 1.

Table 1. Sampling Schedule

Monitoring Period	Sample Collection Time
Monthly	Each month of the year
Quarterly	January, April, July, and October
Semiannually	April and October
Annually	October

Field test instruments (such as those used to test pH, dissolved oxygen, and electrical conductivity) may be used if they are used by a State Water Board Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program accredited laboratory, or:

1. The user is trained in proper use and maintenance of the instruments;
2. The instruments are field calibrated prior to monitoring events at the frequency recommended by the manufacturer;
3. Instruments are serviced and/or calibrated by the manufacturer at the recommended frequency; and
4. Field calibration reports are maintained and available for at least three years.

- B. Monitoring Location Descriptions** – All samples including influent samples (IS), effluent samples (ES), and groundwater monitoring well samples (MW) must be collected at the locations described in Table 2. These locations must be consistent with the Central Coast Water Board approved sampling and analysis plan. Groundwater monitoring locations are shown in Figure 1 in the notice of applicability Attachment 2. Influent and effluent sampling locations are shown in Figure 1 of this monitoring and reporting program. The City of Atascadero **must upload the GeoTracker field point information for each sampling location in the GeoTracker database once, prior to uploading laboratory data (see Table 11).**

Table 2. Sample Identification Details

GeoTracker Field Point Class	GeoTracker Field Point Name (Sample ID)	GeoTracker Field Point Description
Influent Sample	IS-1	Raw wastewater sample collected at the headworks.

GeoTracker Field Point Class	GeoTracker Field Point Name (Sample ID)	GeoTracker Field Point Description
Effluent Sample	ES-1	Treated wastewater sample collected at the post-aeration effluent structure.
Water Supply Well 1	WSW-1 ^[1]	Representative samples of the City of Atascadero's raw water supply.
Monitoring Well 1	MW-1	Shallow upgradient ("Upstream Well") well 25S/12E-24B4.
Monitoring Well 2	MW-2	Shallow downgradient ("Downstream Well") well MW-583817
Monitoring Well 3	MW-3	Irrigation well located 600 feet northeast of the percolation ponds that supplies Chalk Mountain Golf Course

^[1] Water supply sample data should be included in the annual report but does not need to be uploaded to GeoTracker if the Central Coast Water Board approves submittal of a Well Identification Number pursuant to the Water Supply Monitoring section below.

2. WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

A. Potable Water Supply Monitoring - Representative samples of the City of Atascadero's raw water supply (sampled before use or treatment) must be collected and analyzed, at a minimum, for constituents specified in Table 3.

In lieu of the required water supply sampling, the City of Atascadero may submit a Well Identification Number and the reporting year's consumer confidence report (annual water quality report or drinking water quality report), as required by the State Water Board Division of Drinking Water and/or county, provided, at a minimum, all of the required constituents are sampled at the frequency specified in Table 3. The City of Atascadero must report the results of any constituent monitored more frequently than is required by the monitoring program shown in Table 3. The City of Atascadero must also report detectable concentrations (above the reporting limit) for any other constituent that has a published maximum contaminant level (MCL).

The City of Atascadero must evaluate and provide a tabular summary of the water supply data with the annual monitoring report.

Table 3. Water Supply Monitoring

Constituent	Units ^[1]	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Annually

Constituent	Units ^[1]	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Annually

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter

B. Irrigation Water Quality Monitoring - An irrigation well located approximately 600 feet to the north of the disposal ponds (Figure 1 in the notice of applicability Attachment 2, *Irrigation Well*) provides irrigation water to the Chalk Mountain Golf Course. Representative samples of raw irrigation water (sampled before use or treatment) must be collected and analyzed, at a minimum, for constituents specified in, whenever the well is being pumped.

		MW-3	MW-3
Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency ^[1]
Volume pumped	Gallons	Meter	Continuous
Total Coliform	MPN/100mL ^[2]	Grab	Weekly

[1] Monitoring only required if the Irrigation well was pumped in the previous 30 days

[2] MPN/100mL denotes most probable number per 100 milliliters

C. Irrigation Water Use Monitoring—The City of Atascadero must submit photo documentation with each annual monitoring report showing that Chalk Mountain Golf Course has signage notifying the public that irrigation water stored in golf course ponds and applied to golf course landscaping is not for potable use.

In addition, the City of Atascadero must certify in each annual report that no cross-connections exist between irrigation system plumbing and potable water plumbing at Chalk Mountain Golf Course.

Because irrigation at Chalk Mountain Golf Course is operated by the County of San Luis Obispo, the City must coordinate with the County regarding submittal of irrigation water use monitoring documentation.

3. INFLUENT AND EFFLUENT MONITORING

A. Influent and Effluent Flow Monitoring – The City of Atascadero must monitor and report flow in gallons per day, as described in Table 4, with each monitoring report. See monitoring and reporting program section 7.B for supplemental volumetric annual reporting requirements established by the State Water Board.

Table 4. Influent and Effluent Flow Monitoring

	INFLUENT IS-1	INFLUENT IS-1	EFFLUENT ES-1	EFFLUENT ES-1
Parameter	Sample Type	Reporting Frequency	Sample Type	Reporting Frequency
Daily Flow	Metered	Daily	Metered	Daily
Maximum Daily Flow	Metered	Monthly	Metered	Monthly
Monthly Average Flow ^[1]	Calculated	Monthly	Calculated	Monthly
Percent of Permitted Flow ^[2]	Calculated	Quarterly	N/A	N/A

[1] Monthly average flow rate is the total discharge to the headworks by volume during a calendar month divided by the number of days in the month that the wastewater system was discharging.

[2] The General Permit notice of applicability specifies the Wastewater System's maximum permitted flow. In the monitoring reports, the City of Atascadero must evaluate and provide a comparison of monitored flow to the permitted flow.

B. Wastewater System Monitoring – Representative samples of the City of Atascadero's influent (raw wastewater) into the Wastewater System and effluent (treated wastewater) discharged to land must be collected and analyzed in accordance with the treatment technology-based monitoring requirements (including sample type and frequency) summarized in the tables below. See Figure 1 for the location of samples and GeoTracker field points.

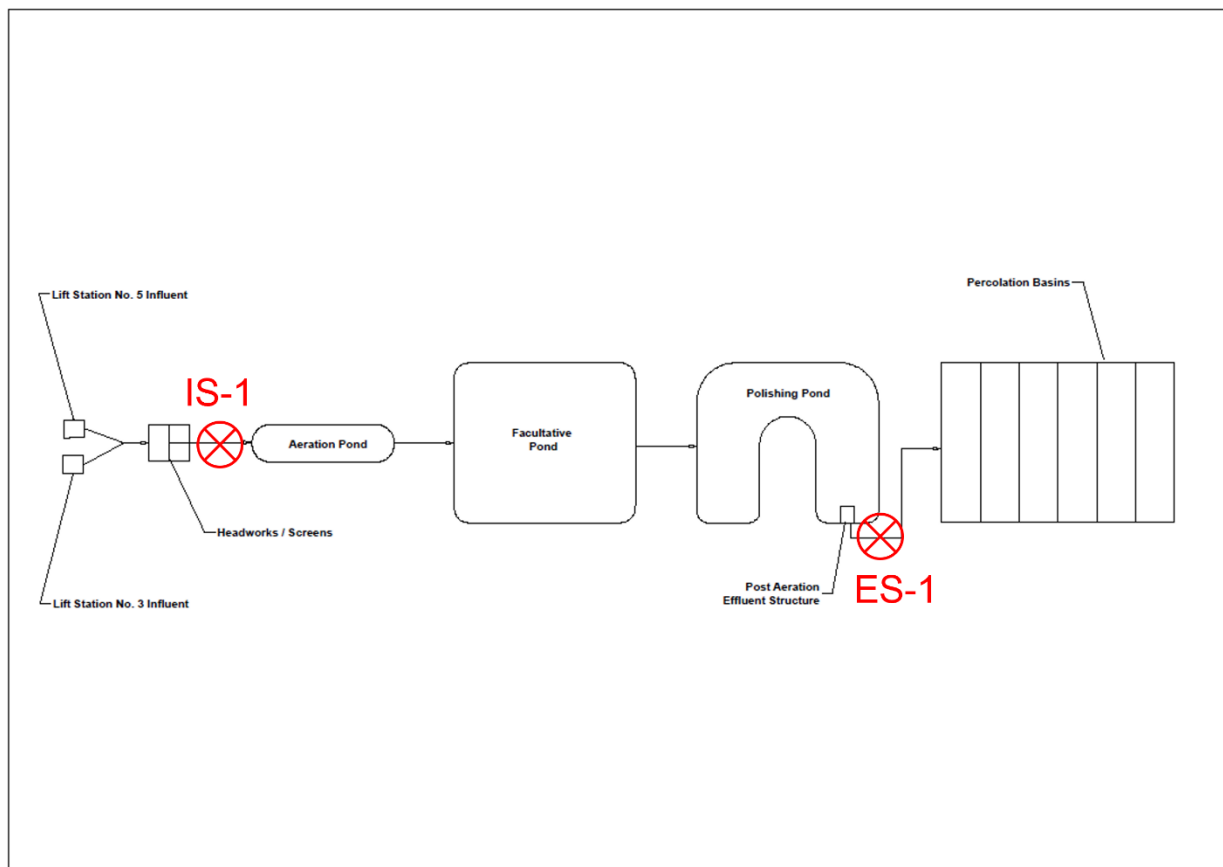


Figure 1. Process Flow Diagram and Sample Locations Referenced in Table 2

C. Pond System Monitoring

- i. **Required Pond Monitoring** – All wastewater treatment and treated wastewater storage/disposal ponds (lined and unlined) must be monitored as specified in Table 5.

Table 5. Wastewater Treatment/Storage/Disposal Pond Monitoring

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling/Monitoring Frequency
Freeboard	0.1 feet	Measured	Weekly
pH	pH Units	Grab	Weekly
Dissolved Oxygen (in pond)	mg/L	Grab	Monthly
Odors	Not Applicable	Observation	Weekly
Berm condition	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Sludge Depth	0.1 feet	Measured	Annually

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling/Monitoring Frequency
Precipitation	inches/day and date	Measured ^[1]	Each precipitation event ^[2]

[1] The City of Atascadero may use a rain gauge or use a National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, United States Geological Survey, or California Irrigation Management Information System weather station, such as <http://scacis.rcc-acis.org/>

[2] A precipitation event is a rain event producing ½ inch or more precipitation within a consecutive 48-hour period.

- ii. **Influent and Effluent Monitoring** – At a minimum, influent and effluent constituent monitoring for pond treatment systems must be monitored as specified in Table 6.

Table 6. Influent and Effluent Monitoring for Pond Treatment Systems

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
pH	units	Grab	Weekly	Grab	Weekly
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Settleable Solids	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Weekly
Total Nitrogen ^[2]	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly	Calculated	Quarterly
Nitrate (as N) + Nitrite (as N) or separate species	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Chloride	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Sodium	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Sulfate	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Quarterly
Boron	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Quarterly

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Carbonate	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Semiannually
Calcium	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Semiannually
Magnesium	mg/L	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Grab	Semiannually

[1] Total nitrogen is the sum of total inorganic nitrogen (nitrate + nitrite + ammonium + ammonia) and organic nitrogen.

D. Effluent Monitoring – Pond treatment system wastewater effluent monitoring for select constituents is required because the Wastewater System receives wastewater from recreational vehicle dump stations and restaurants in the City of Atascadero.

Effluent monitoring for select constituents shall be consistent with Table 7.

Table 7. Effluent Monitoring for Select Constituents for Pond Treatment Systems

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Phenol	µg/L ^[1]	Grab	Quarterly
Formaldehyde	µg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Zinc	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly

[1] µg/L denotes micrograms per liter

4. WASTEWATER DISPOSAL MONITORING

The City of Atascadero must monitor all wastewater disposal areas (e.g., land application areas, percolation ponds) when wastewater and/or supplemental irrigation water is applied. Inspections (observations) must be conducted as described in Table 8. Notations must be made in a bound logbook and problems must be promptly corrected and recorded. A log of these inspections must be maintained onsite and made available to Central Coast Water Board upon inspection. Observations do not need to be reported in the monitoring reports unless a violation of permit conditions is observed. If violations are observed, planned and implemented mitigation measures to address the violations must be reported.

The City of Atascadero must evaluate and summarize wastewater disposal application rates, loading rates (pounds/acre/day), violations found during the inspections, with each monitoring report.

If wastewater and/or supplemental irrigation water is not discharged to land during a reporting period, the monitoring report must still be submitted and indicate that there was no discharge during the reporting period.

Table 8. Wastewater Disposal Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Monitoring Frequency
Local Precipitation	Inches/day	Weather Station ^[1]	Each precipitation event
Acreage Applied ^[2]	Acres	Measured	Daily
Application Rate	Gallons per day	Metered/Estimated ^[3]	Daily
Average Monthly Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day (BOD) Applied ^[4] ^[5]	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Total Nitrogen Applied ^[4] ^[5]	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Salts Applied ^[4] ^[5] (total dissolved solids, sodium, chloride, sulfate, boron)	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Soil Erosion Evidence	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Containment Berm Condition	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Soil Saturation/Ponding	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Nuisance Odors/Vectors	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Discharge Offsite	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly

[1] The City of Atascadero must have a rain gauge or use a NOAA or USGS rain station, such as <http://scacis.rcc-acis.org/>.

[2] Acreage applied denotes the acreage to which wastewater is applied.

[3] Requires meter reading, a pump run time meter, or other approved method. If the flow is estimated, the City of Atascadero is required to provide an explanation (e.g., no meter- estimated using pump operations including rate and time) with each monitoring report.

[4] The total nitrogen, salts, and BOD applied loading rates must be calculated from wastewater flow volumes, applied acreage, and concentrations reported in effluent analytical testing as follows:

Total Nitrogen/Salts/BOD Applied (pounds/acre/ day) =

$$\frac{X \text{ [mg/L]} \times Q \text{ [million gallons per day]} \times 8.34 \text{ [(conversion from mg/L to pounds/million gallons per day)]}}{\text{Acreage Applied [acres]}}$$

Where X = Total nitrogen, salts, or BOD concentration

Where Q = Application Rate (often effluent flow rate)

- [5] Frequencies of analytical testing are defined in the influent and effluent monitoring tables (Table 6 and Table 7).

5. SLUDGE/BIOSOLIDS DISPOSAL MONITORING

The City of Atascadero must report the handling and disposal of all sludge/biosolids generated at the Wastewater System. Records must include the date removed from the Wastewater System, name/contact information for the hauling company, the type and volume of waste transported, the disposal facility name and address, and copies of analytical data required by the entity accepting the waste. These records must be submitted as part of the annual monitoring report.

The City of Atascadero must also monitor sludge/biosolids consistent with a Central Coast Water Board approved sludge management plan and in accordance with the requirements specified by the receiving party, including a regulated landfill and/or regulated composting facility.

If sludge/biosolids are not removed during the year, the City of Atascadero must explain the absence of this monitoring in the annual report.

6. GROUNDWATER MONITORING

The City of Atascadero must:

- A. **By October 6, 2023**, submit a groundwater monitoring workplan and preliminary hydrogeologic conceptual site model for Central Coast Water Board approval. At a minimum, the workplan must describe how the monitoring program will be able to evaluate the impacts of wastewater discharge on ambient groundwater quality. The plan must identify the number and location of groundwater monitoring wells in the monitoring network. Well depths and screened intervals must be included in the work plan.
- B. All monitoring wells in the groundwater monitoring network must be, at a minimum, sampled and analyzed as specified in Table 9 and the Central Coast Water Board approved sampling and analysis plan (see section VI.A.2.i of the General Permit).

Prior to sampling, depth to groundwater must be measured and groundwater elevations⁵ must be calculated. The monitoring wells must be purged of at least three well volumes and until measurements of the following parameters have stabilized (i.e., are reproducible within 10 percent): pH, temperature, dissolved oxygen, electrical conductivity, and turbidity. No-purge, low-flow, or other sampling techniques are acceptable only if they are approved in advance by the Central Coast Water Board and described in an approved sampling and analysis

⁵ The locations and top-of-casing elevations for the existing groundwater monitoring wells must be surveyed by a licensed land surveyor if not already completed at the time of installation.

plan. Once the groundwater level in each of the wells has recovered sufficiently to ensure the collection of representative groundwater samples, a qualified individual (e.g., consultant, technician) trained in using proper sampling methods must recover samples using approved USEPA methods. Laboratories analyzing groundwater samples must be accredited by the State Water Board Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program, in accordance with California Water Code section 13176, and must include quality assurance/quality control data with their reports.

The City of Atascadero must provide monitoring well field sheets and report monitoring data, as described in Table 9, with each monitoring report.

- C. Groundwater monitoring must occur for monitoring wells 1 and 2 (MW-1 and MW-2) and must be consistent with Table 9.

Table 9. Groundwater Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Groundwater Elevation ^[1]	0.01 ft msl	Calculated	Quarterly
Depth to Groundwater ^[1]	0.01 ft bgs	Measurement	Quarterly
Total Nitrogen ^[2]	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Nitrite (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
pH	pH Units	Metered	Quarterly
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	Metered	Quarterly
Electrical Conductivity	µS/cm ^[3]	Metered	Quarterly
Oxidation Reduction Potential	mV ^[4]	Metered	Quarterly
Temperature	degrees Celsius	Metered	Quarterly
Phenol ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly ^[5]
Formaldehyde ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly ^[5]
Zinc ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly ^[5]

- [1] ft.msl denotes feet above mean sea level and ft bgs denotes feet below ground surface.
 [2] Total nitrogen is the sum of total inorganic nitrogen (nitrate + nitrite + ammonium + ammonia) and organic nitrogen.
 [3] µS/cm denotes microsiemens per centimeter
 [3] mV denotes millivolts
 [4] Constituent monitoring is based on raw wastewater characteristics (waste streams). If the City of Atascadero is required to monitor effluent for this constituent, the City of Atascadero must also analyze groundwater for the potential presence of this constituent.
 [5] Sampling required once every five years if not detected in initial sample.

7. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

A. QUARTERLY AND ANNUAL MONITORING REPORTS

Quarterly and annual monitoring reports are due as described in Table 10.

Table 10. Quarterly and Annual Monitoring Reporting

Report	Monitoring Period	Report Due Date
First Quarter Monitoring Report	January 1 to March 31	May 1
Second Quarter Monitoring Report	April 1 to June 30	August 1
Third Quarter Monitoring Report	July 1 to September 30	November 1
Fourth Quarter Monitoring Report	October 1 to December 31	February 1
Annual Report	January 1 to December 31	March 1
State Water Board Volumetric Annual Reporting	January 1 to December 31	April 30

a. Quarterly Monitoring Reporting – At a minimum, the quarterly reports must include:

- i. Results of all required monitoring in tabular format.
- ii. The results of any pollutant or parameter monitored more frequently than is required by this monitoring program. Values obtained through additional monitoring must be used in calculations as appropriate.
- iii. A comparison of monitoring data to the discharge specifications, applicable effluent limitations, disclosure of any violations of the notice of applicability and/or General Permit, and an explanation of any violation of those requirements. **The City of Atascadero must calculate 7-day averages, 30-day averages and 25-month rolling medians for select analytes when comparing monitoring data to applicable effluent limitations specified in the General Permit.** Data must be presented in tabular format.
- iv. Copies of laboratory analytical report(s) and chain of custody form(s).
- v. Copies of groundwater monitoring well field sheets with purge methods and data.

b. Annual Reporting – The City of Atascadero must submit annual reports in compliance with Standard Provisions 2013⁶, (and any updates to the Standard Provisions) Section C, General Reporting Requirements, Item 16 using the most recent annual report template provided by Central Coast Water Board.

The current annual report template can be found here:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

B. STATE WATER BOARD VOLUMETRIC ANNUAL REPORTING – The City of Atascadero must electronically certify and submit a summary of the monthly influent and effluent flow volume by April 30th of each calendar year via the State Water Board's Internet GeoTracker database.⁷

The following information is required:

- i. Monthly volume of wastewater collected and treated by the wastewater treatment plant (i.e. total monthly influent volume).
- ii. Monthly volume of wastewater treated, specifying level of treatment, including treated wastewater discharged.

⁶ See Attachment E, Standard Provisions, 2013:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/docs/wdr_standard_provisions_2013.pdf

⁷ See: <https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

- iii. If applicable, monthly volume of recycled water distributed, and annual volume of treated wastewater distributed for beneficial use in compliance with California Code of Regulations, title 22 use categories.

Additional information about volumetric annual reporting of wastewater and recycled water and the Recycled Water Policy is available at the Recycled Water Policy Volumetric Annual Reporting Website⁸.

C. NON-COMPLIANCE REPORTING:

The City of Atascadero must notify and report to Central Coast Water Board noncompliance of limits related to pond freeboard, flow rate, bypass or overflow, wastewater containment failure, pursuant to General Permit section VI.C.2.

D. ELECTRONIC GEOTRACKER SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports must be provided electronically in a searchable PDF format, with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permiiting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

The City of Atascadero must submit all reports/documents and laboratory analytical data to the State Water Board's GeoTracker^{9,10} database consistent with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System-specific global identification number WDR100026749 at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login>

For general questions, please contact the GeoTracker Help Desk at:

Geotracker@waterboards.ca.gov.

Table 11 summarizes all the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

⁸ See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

⁹ Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/docs/beginnerguid2.pdf

¹⁰ Additional information available at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

Table 11. GeoTracker Electronic Submittal Information Data Requirements

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Reports and Documents	Complete copy of all documents including monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents related to the Wastewater System.	Upload directly to GeoTracker all monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents.	On or before the due dates required by this General Permit and for other documents when required by the Central Coast Water Board.
Laboratory Data	All analytical data (including geochemical data) in electronic deliverable format (EDF). This includes all water, soil, and vapor samples collected when monitoring a discharge.	Upload, or direct your California ELAP-accredited laboratory staff to upload, all EDF laboratory data directly to GeoTracker.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Depth to Groundwater	Monitoring wells must have the depth-to-water information reported. Report data only for wells defined as permanent sampling points.	Upload depth-to-water information to the GeoTracker GEO_WELL file.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Boring Logs and Well Screen Intervals	Boring logs must be prepared by a registered professional and submitted in PDF format separately (not only as attachments to reports).	Upload boring logs (in searchable PDF format) to GeoTracker GEO_BORE file whenever a new boring is drilled.	Every time a new boring is drilled.
Field Points, Location Data (Geo XY) ^[1]	Name, classify, and identify the location (latitude and longitude) of all sampling points. Monitoring wells must be surveyed, influent and effluent sample locations must be identified on the GeoTracker mapping tool under "non-surveyed data." These data points are required prior to laboratory data uploads.	Upload the location data (surveyed and non-surveyed) to the GeoTracker Geo_XY file.	Every time a permanent monitoring point is established.

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Elevation Data (Geo Z) ^[2]	Survey and mark the elevation at the top of groundwater well casings for all permanent groundwater wells. These points are required prior to depth-to-water data uploads.	Upload the survey data to the GeoTracker GEO_Z file.	One-time, for all groundwater monitoring wells.
Geo Map	Site layout, map of facilities, Wastewater System including treatment and disposal area(s).	Upload the Site layout PDF to the GeoTracker site plan file.	Year one and every five years thereafter and when the facilities are modified.

[1] Geo XY required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data. The City of Atascadero must also upload sample locations (e.g., influent and effluent samples) that are not defined as a **permanent monitoring well** and have not been surveyed by a licensed professional.

[2] Geo Z required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data.

8. TECHNICAL REPORTS

The technical reports are due as described in Table 12.

Table 12. Technical Report Submittal Due Dates

Report	Report Due Date
Operations and Maintenance Manual	June 6, 2024
Climate Change Adaptation Plan	June 6, 2025
Time Schedule Compliance Plan	June 6, 2024
Groundwater Monitoring Plan	October 6, 2023
Capital Improvement Plan	June 6, 2024

- 1. Pretreatment Program Plan** – A Pretreatment Program is not required at this time. If the Central Coast Water Board notifies the City of Atascadero that development of a Pretreatment Program Plan is required, submit a plan that meets the requirements specified in General Permit section IV.F.2.i and General Permit section VI.A.1. The plan must contain an implementation schedule and identification of adequate funding to implement the plan.
- 2. Time Schedule Compliance Plan** - As set forth in General Permit sections V.A and VI.A.5, the City of Atascadero anticipates that additional time is needed to achieve compliance with the effluent limitations and treatment capacity, therefore, the City of Atascadero must prepare and submit for Central Coast

Water Board review and approval, a time schedule compliance plan. Specifically, the time schedule compliance plan must address how the City of Atascadero plans to comply with permit limits for total dissolved solids, sodium, chloride, and total nitrogen or nitrate (depending on the compliance path chosen). At a minimum, the time schedule compliance plan must address the following:

- i. Comparison of the current effluent quality to the effluent and groundwater limitations in General Permit Tables 3-6.
- ii. A detailed description of salinity and nitrogen reduction actions and studies that the City of Atascadero will perform to achieve compliance with relevant permit limits including:
 - a. An evaluation of the prevalence of water softener use by the City's wastewater customers. If the evaluation demonstrates substantial salt additions from water softeners, then the City must include a plan for adopting a water softener use ordinance or other effective method.
 - b. An evaluation of salt additions occurring in the wastewater treatment process and the feasibility of utilizing lower salt treatment options.
 - c. An evaluation of other strategies for reducing salt concentration in treated effluent.
 - d. An evaluation of wastewater treatment processes that could be implemented to reduce nitrogen concentrations in effluent.
- iii. Comparison of the current influent daily average and daily maximum influent flow and the Wastewater System's design capacity.
- iv. A detailed description and chronology of efforts, since issuance of the notice of applicability, to reduce wastes.
- v. Justification of the need for additional time to achieve the effluent limitations in General Permit Tables 3-6.
- vi. A detailed time schedule of specific actions the City of Atascadero will take to achieve the effluent limitations and daily average and maximum daily flows to be less than 80% of the Wastewater System design capacity.
- vii. A demonstration that the time schedule requested is as short as possible, considering the technological, operation, and economic factors that affect the design, development, and implementation of the measures that are necessary to comply with the effluent limitation(s).
- viii. If the requested time schedule exceeds one year, the proposed schedule shall include interim requirements and the date(s) for their achievement. The interim requirements shall include both of the following:
 - a. Effluent limitation(s) for the pollutant(s) of concern.
 - b. Control and management of daily average and maximum flows.
 - c. Actions, measurable milestones, and tangible products leading to compliance with the effluent limitation(s).

3. Operations and Maintenance Manual – In addition to the required components specified in Standard Provisions¹¹ A.12 and A.28 (and any updates to the Standard Provisions) and General Permit section VI.A.2, the Operations and Maintenance Manual must contain the following components. Each component must contain an implementation schedule and identification of adequate funding to implement the component.

- i. **Sampling and Analysis Plan** – The City of Atascadero’s Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a sampling and analysis plan that meets the requirements specified herein. Anyone performing sampling on behalf of the City of Atascadero must be familiar with the sampling and analysis plan. At a minimum, the sampling and analysis plan must contain the following:
 - a. A wastewater treatment process flow schematic with the monitoring locations labeled and scaled Wastewater System maps with treatment components, discharge locations (both treated wastewater and non-potable recycled water), monitoring locations, groundwater wells, storage locations (e.g., chemical, sludge, emergency overflow ponds), and buildings. If the City of Atascadero needs to update Figure 1 to comply with this requirement, a copy of the updated process flow schematic will also be included with the annual report .
 - b. Sample identification details in tabular format. The table must include the sample titles, GeoTracker field point information, sample description(s), and sampling frequencies.
 - c. Sample chain-of-custody procedures and documentation.
 - d. Sample handling/preservation procedures.
 - e. A description of the analytical methods.
 - f. A description of sample containers, preservatives, and holding times.
 - g. For water supply monitoring, a description of the location and method of data collection (e.g., onsite well sampling, use of consumer confidence report).
 - h. For groundwater monitoring, a description of the well purging and field methods.
- ii. **Sludge Management Plan** – The City of Atascadero’s Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a sludge management plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and

¹¹ See Attachment E, Standard Provisions, 2013:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/do-cs/wdr_standard_provisions_2013.pdf

the notice of applicability. At a minimum, the plan must describe the following:

- a. An estimated volume/amount and quality of sludge and scum that will be generated.
 - b. How sludge, scum, and supernatant will be stored and disposed of to protect groundwater quality.
 - c. If sludge will be subject to further treatment, describe the treatment and storage requirements.
 - d. Procedures for cleaning of digesters or storage vessels and the treatment and disposal of the residuals. If drying of residuals is planned, describe how that will be performed to prevent nuisance odors, prevent vectors, and protect groundwater quality.
- iii. **Wastewater Disposal Management Plan** – The City of Atascadero's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a wastewater disposal management plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and the notice of applicability. At a minimum, the wastewater disposal management plan must include:
 - a. A description of the wastewater disposal area and a map denoting acreage.
 - b. Loading calculations based on flow volumes, applied acreage, and biochemical oxygen demand, salts (total dissolved solids, sodium, chloride, sulfate, boron), and nitrogen analytical results.
 - c. A description of wastewater disposal and water quality protection practices.
- iv. **Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan** – The City of Atascadero's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a spill prevention and emergency response plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and the notice of applicability. The spill prevention and emergency response plan must describe operation and maintenance activities to prevent accidental releases of wastewater and to effectively respond to such releases and minimize the environmental impact. At a minimum, the spill prevention and emergency response plan must address the following:
 - a. Operation and Control of Wastewater System - A description of the wastewater treatment equipment, operational controls, flow measurement and calibration procedures, and treatment system schematic including valve/gate locations.
 - b. Sludge Handling - A description of the sludge handling equipment, operational controls, and disposal procedures.

- c. **Collection System Maintenance** - A description of collection system cleaning and maintenance, equipment tests, and alarm functionality tests to minimize the potential for wastewater spills originating in the collection system or headworks. For collection systems subject to State Water Board Order No. 2006-0003-DWQ, Statewide General Waste Discharge Requirements for Sanitary Sewer Systems (or its replacement), reports prepared to comply with State Water Board Order No. 2006-0003-DWQ satisfy this requirement.
- d. **Emergency Response** - A description of emergency response procedures including for emergencies such as power outage, severe weather, flooding, or inadequate freeboard (for systems with wastewater treatment, storage, or disposal ponds or treated non-potable recycled water storage ponds). An equipment and telephone list for contractors/consultants, emergency personnel, and equipment vendors.
- e. **Finance** - At a minimum, discuss current fees, projected fees, current budget for spill prevention and emergency response, projected budget for spill prevention and emergency response.
- f. **Notification Procedures** - Coordination procedures with fire, police, Governor's Office of Emergency Services (CalOES), Central Coast Water Board, and local county health department personnel.
- v. **Training Records Log** – The City of Atascadero's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain updated training records logs that demonstrates the City of Atascadero is complying with General Permit section VI.B.3.

4. Climate Change Adaptation –The Climate Change Adaptation Plan must, at a minimum, include the following components:

- i. **Hazards and Vulnerabilities** – Identify climate change hazards, at a minimum accounting for the hazards listed below, applicable to the Wastewater System. Using up-to-date tools, data, and guidance from the State of California (e.g., Cal-Adapt¹², Sea-Level Rise Guidance from Ocean Protection Council, reports from the Climate-Safe Infrastructure Working Group, the Climate Adaptation Planning Guide, and California Climate Assessment Regional Reports), assess the Wastewater System's vulnerability to identified hazards that could cause reduction, loss, or

¹² Cal-Adapt is an online resource with downscaled climate project data. It provides users with projections and more detailed downloadable data supporting a range of needs and array of climate models and emissions scenarios. Cal-Adapt offers climate projections for the major stressors facing California, including the following: temperature averages and extremes, precipitation averages and extremes, sea-level rise, wildfires, and drought. The Governor's Office of Planning and Research (OPR) recommends agencies use Representative Concentration Pathway (RCP) 8.5 for analyses considering impacts through 2050, because there are minimal differences between emissions scenarios during the first half of the 21st century.

failure of treatment processes and/or critical structures at the Wastewater System. Identify and justify the resources (e.g., models and tools, design parameters) used to inform identification of these hazards and vulnerabilities.

- a. Sea Level Rise – Saltwater intrusion, flooding and inundation, and increased coastal erosion.
- b. Precipitation Pattern Changes.
 - I. Drought – Decreased influent quantity and quality.
 - II. Peak Events – Flooding and increased influent quantity.
- c. Temperature fluctuations and extremes.
- d. Increased wildfires.
- e. Increased power outages.
- ii. Resiliency Actions – Identify actions to build Wastewater System and operational resilience to identified vulnerabilities, accounting for options that minimize resource impacts.
- iii. Adaptation Strategy – For Wastewater Systems with design flows over 1,000,000 gallons per day, develop and implement a strategy to complete resiliency actions, at a minimum encompassing the following:
 - a. Prioritization – Prioritized resiliency actions based on risks to water quality, but also accounting for costs and benefits.
 - b. Schedule and Milestones – Timeframes to complete prioritized resiliency actions and/or climate change hazard triggers to inform when the City of Atascadero must implement actions. Milestones to complete critical steps for prioritized resiliency actions, designed to demonstrate measurable progress at a steady, or accelerated, completion pace over the established timeframes.
 - c. Financial Planning – Projected costs necessary to implement and sustain resiliency actions and strategy to procure funds.
- iv. Recycled Water Feasibility Plan – Dischargers with Wastewater System design flows over 1,000,000 gallons per day must include a recycled water feasibility plan.

The recycled water feasibility plan will assess the viability of using the Wastewater System's treated wastewater effluent for beneficial reuse including, but not limited to the following:

- a. Beneficial Reuse Options – Identification of reuse opportunities for the City of Atascadero's treated effluent that would achieve the highest beneficial impact and best uses possible of non-potable recycled water. Include assessment of the following non-potable recycled water benefits identified in the State Water Board Recycled Water Policy: providing safe alternatives to fresh water or potable water for approved

uses; supporting sustainable groundwater and surface water uses with the intent of substituting use of treated effluent for use of fresh water or potable water; and diversifying community water supplies and mitigating for the impacts of climate change.¹³

- b. Viable Users – Identification and viability evaluation of all potential users of the Wastewater System’s treated effluent associated with identified beneficial reuse options. The City of Atascadero must demonstrate it engaged potential water purveyors and customers about the viability of reusing the Wastewater System’s treated effluent.
- c. Infrastructure Upgrades – Assessment of infrastructure needs to produce non-potable recycled water for identified beneficial reuses and convey non-potable recycled water to beneficial reuse locations.
- d. Fiscal Analysis – Cost estimates for identified reuse options, at a minimum including project development, construction, and long-term maintenance and lifecycle costs. This analysis shall also include identification and evaluation of the following: 1) funding options, including at a minimum, revenues from recycled water sales, grant and loan funding opportunities, and financing from other benefitting parties and 2) funding limitations.
- e. Schedule and Milestones for Next Steps – Timeframes to assess the feasibility of identified beneficial reuse options and to identify proposed beneficial reuse options based on prioritized water recycling and reuse opportunities, feasibility assessments, and other factors identified by the City of Atascadero .
- f. Identification of implementation schedule and adequate funding to implement the plan.

5. Capital Improvements Plan – The City of Atascadero must prepare and submit a Capital Improvement Plan. The Capital Improvement Plan must contain all significant capital projects, equipment purchases, and major studies needed for operating the City of Atascadero Wastewater Treatment Facility. In general, the Capital Improvement Plan must include the following elements:

- i. Estimated overall cost of each project
- ii. Age and remaining useful life expectancy of critical equipment on-site
- iii. Estimated operational and maintenance costs for each project
- iv. Estimated project timelines
- v. Funding sources

¹³ [Water Quality Control Policy for Recycled Water](#), State Water Board, adopted December 11, 2018, page 1.

vi. Project prioritization

9. LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

The Central Coast Water Board's requirements that the City of Atascadero submit the technical and monitoring reports described in this monitoring and reporting program are made pursuant to [section 13267 of the California Water Code](#). Failure to submit reports in accordance with schedules established by this General Permit and notice of applicability with attachments or failure to submit a report of sufficient technical quality to be acceptable to the Central Coast Water Board may subject the City of Atascadero to enforcement action pursuant to section 13268 of the California Water Code. Pursuant to [section 13268 of the Water Code](#), a violation of a request made pursuant to section 13267 may subject the City of Atascadero to civil liability assessment of up to \$1,000 per day in which the violation occurs.

The Central Coast Water Board needs the required information to ensure compliance with the notice of applicability and the General Permit. The City of Atascadero is required to submit this information because it is subject to the General Permit and is responsible for the discharge.

The burden, including costs, of the reports bears a reasonable relationship to their need and the benefits to be obtained. The requirement for the reports is necessary to ensure compliance with the General Permit, notice of applicability, and monitoring and reporting program to protect water quality.

The City of Atascadero must implement the above monitoring program on July 1, 2023. The Central Coast Water Board may rescind or modify this monitoring and reporting program at any time.

Ordered By:

Jennifer Epp
Digitally signed by Jennifer Epp
Date: 2023.06.06 12:22:57
-07'00'
Water Boards

for Matthew T. Keeling
Executive Officer

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